IELTS ACADEMIC · WRITING TASK 2

Building a body paragraph with PEEL

Argument structure for Writing Task 2

LESSON	DURATION	PREPARED FOR	TARGET	TUTOR
Lesson 7	60 min	Jordan	Band 6.0 to 6.5	Lin Chen

Today’s objectives

GOALS

BY THE END OF THIS LESSON, YOU CAN

1. Name the four PEEL moves and what each one does.
2. Turn a vague opinion into one precise, arguable Point sentence.
3. Write a 120–150-word body paragraph in eight minutes.

BAND FOCUS

Task Response · Coherence and Cohesion

From last week's essay

DIAGNOSE

STUDENT'S SENTENCE

Nowadays, many people thinks[1] that study other subject[2] is waste of time[3], but I think it have many advantage[4].

REVISED

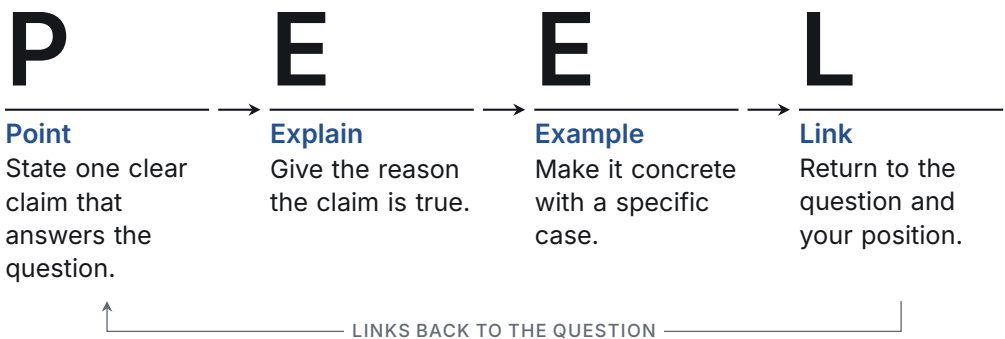
Requiring students to take courses outside their major has one clear advantage: it develops the flexible thinking that employers value.

WHY

1. *many people think*: plural subject, plural verb
2. *studying other subjects*: a gerund as subject
3. *a waste of time*: the noun needs an article
4. *it has*, and name the advantage you mean

Four moves, one argument

STRUCTURE



Most Band 6 paragraphs jump from Point straight to Example. Explain is the move that lifts the band.

Say it before you write it

SPEAK FIRST

IELTS SPEAKING · PART 2

1 min to prepare · 1–2 min to speak

Describe a subject you studied that was not part of your main interest.

You should say:

- what the subject was
- when and where you studied it
- what you learned from it

and explain whether you think it was worth studying.

Jordan speaks first. Then they write the same idea as one PEEL paragraph.

Write one body paragraph

PRACTISE

8:00

COUNTDOWN

QUESTION

Some people believe that university students should be required to take courses outside their main subject. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

0–1 min	Plan: choose one Point and one example.
1–6 min	Write 120–150 words in PEEL order.
6–8 min	Check verb agreement, articles and the Link.

A model paragraph, move by move

MODEL

POINT

The strongest argument for compulsory courses outside a student's major is that they build transferable thinking skills.

One claim, and no examples yet.

A model paragraph, move by move

MODEL

POINT

The strongest argument for compulsory courses outside a student's major is that they build transferable thinking skills.

EXPLAIN

Unfamiliar subjects force students to question their assumptions instead of applying familiar methods automatically.

The reasoning: why the claim holds.

A model paragraph, move by move

MODEL

POINT	The strongest argument for compulsory courses outside a student's major is that they build transferable thinking skills.
EXPLAIN	Unfamiliar subjects force students to question their assumptions instead of applying familiar methods automatically.
EXAMPLE	For instance, a computer science student who takes an ethics module learns to ask not only whether software works, but whom it might harm.

Specific and believable, not *many people*.

A model paragraph, move by move

MODEL

POINT	The strongest argument for compulsory courses outside a student's major is that they build transferable thinking skills.
EXPLAIN	Unfamiliar subjects force students to question their assumptions instead of applying familiar methods automatically.
EXAMPLE	For instance, a computer science student who takes an ethics module learns to ask not only whether software works, but whom it might harm.
LINK	Broad requirements therefore produce more adaptable graduates, which is why I largely agree with this policy. Returns to the question and the writer's position.

RULE OF THUMB

One paragraph, one point. Every other sentence serves it.

Summary and exit check

WRAP-UP

TODAY

- A Point makes one specific claim.
- Explain gives the reason; Example makes it concrete.
- The Link answers the question, not the topic.

WORDS TO REUSE

transferable /trænsˈfɜːrəbl/
useful in many situations

compulsory /kəmˈpʌlsəri/
required by rule

EXIT CHECK

1. Which move is missing? “Online study saves time. For example, I save two hours a day.”
2. Correct this sentence: “It have many advantage.”
3. Write a Point sentence for: “Should museums be free?”